

HOSPITALITY IN POLITICS

THE GREEN DRAGON & THE BIRTH OF A NATION

The American Revolution wasn't born in legislative halls—it took shape in taverns. These spaces didn't just support the revolution; they made it structurally possible.

The Green Dragon Tavern in Boston served as the headquarters of the Sons of Liberty. The Green Dragon was where **Samuel Adams, Paul Revere, John Hancock, and James Otis** gathered to plan boycotts of English goods while planning the Boston Tea Party. "they chose tea because they didn't want to lose the rum."^[1] [startavern.net](#)

WHY TAVERNS, NOT HALLS

Early legislature were formal, regulated, and controlled by British-appointed officials. Taverns were none of these things. American Heritage's research describes the dynamic directly: *"In colonial America, [taverns] were places where people would go not only to eat and drink and pass the time, but argue the issues of the day — more and more vehemently as the polarizing view of Great Britain widened."* ^[2] Janet Fortran, *American Heritage*, Vol. 54 Issue 3

Literacy rates were mixed. The tavern were an opportunity to rub shoulders with those who could read. Which helped news spread. Soon, the ideas of the founding fathers was disuccessed in other colonies, and the revolutionary thinking of Thomas Paine, James Chalmers, and Thomas Jefferson took hold."^[1] [startavern.net](#)

THE FRAUNCES TAVERN — WHERE THE WAR ENDED

The Fraunces Tavern on Pearl Street, New York — still standing today — was where **George Washington made his final address to his troops in 1783.**

THE REVOLUTIONARY TAVERN NETWORK

GREEN DRAGON TAVERN, Boston

Sons of Liberty HQ. Adams, Revere, Hancock, Otis organized the Boston Tea Party there.



CITY TAVERN, Philadelphia

Continental Congress delegates met here. Founding Fathers drafted strategy over a good meals and lively drinks.



FRAUNCES TAVERN, New York

Washington's farewell address to troops, 1783. Later housed The Departments of War and Foreign Affairs.

Source: *Star Tavern*, [startavern.net](#)



"Our nation was born in taverns... they were places where people sought companionship, cemented friendships, made business contacts, and found respite from the demanding world outside of it's doors."

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Sources: *Star Tavern* ([startavern.net](#)); Janet Fortran, *American Heritage* Vol. 54 Issue 3